Maharashtra Calling

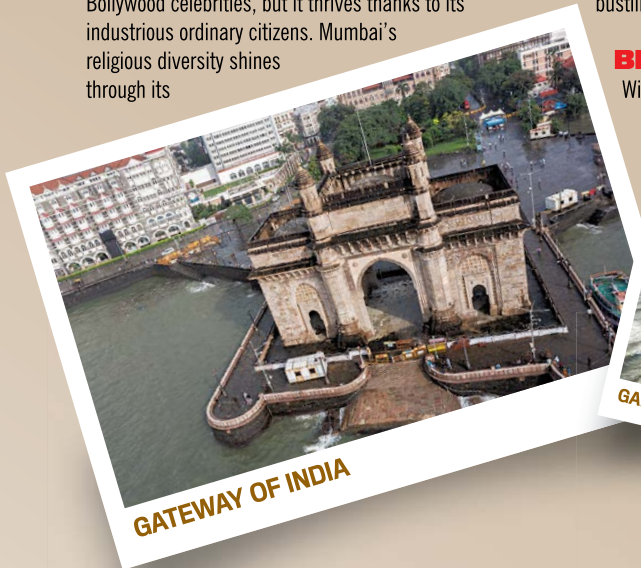
Lying on India's west coast, the state of Maharashtra offers a slew of captivating experiences to travellers—from the vibrant capital Mumbai to beaches, forts, wildlife destinations and scenic vineyards

Nestled along the majestic western coastline of India, Maharashtra beckons travellers with a treasure trove of captivating experiences and diverse landscapes. From the bustling metropolis of Mumbai to the tranquil beaches, historic forts, wildlife reserves and lush hill stations, Maharashtra boasts a tapestry of tourist attractions that cater to every discerning wanderer's tastes. This enchanting state, steeped in history and culture, invites you on a journey to explore its hidden gems, vibrant cities, and natural wonders, promising an unforgettable adventure at every turn.

MUMBAI

The capital Mumbai captivates with its frenetic pace and inclusive spirit. Its Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport is serviced by over 70 airlines which connect it to major cities in India and around the world, while a robust railway network, anchored by the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Terminus, links it to every corner of India. This cosmopolitan hub is home to business tycoons and Bollywood celebrities, but it thrives thanks to its industrious ordinary citizens. Mumbai's religious diversity shines through its temples, churches, and mosques, including the Mumbadevi Temple, Siddhivinayak Temple, and Haji Ali Dargah. Its historic streets boast architectural wonders like the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Terminus and the Gateway of India, while ancient culture and art await at the Elephanta, Kanheri, and Mahakali caves. Attractions also include the Victorian Gothic and Art Deco Ensembles of Mumbai, which is on the UNESCO World Heritage Sites list, and iconic museums like the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Vastu Sangrahalaya and Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Mumbai City Museum.

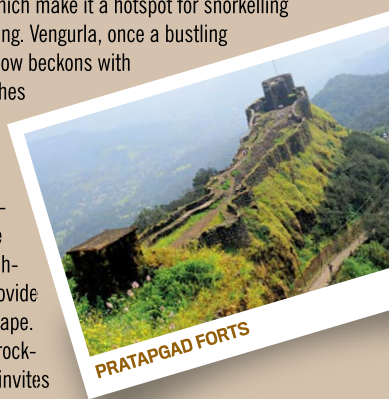
Don't miss the spicy allure of street foods like the vada pav, pav bhaji and bhelpuri. For shoppers, there are several atmospheric markets—Crawford Market for spices and knick-knacks, Zaveri Bazaar for jewellery, Chor Bazaar for antiques and curios, and so on. Wildlife enthusiasts can explore the Sanjay Gandhi National Park, while beachgoers can visit Chowpatty Beach, Juhu Beach, or take in the iconic Marine Drive. In this city that never sleeps, day and night merge seamlessly, with theatres, museums, art galleries, and restaurants always bustling.


GATEWAY OF INDIA

BEACHES

With its 720-kilometre-long coastline along the Arabian Sea, Maharashtra's Konkan Coast boasts some of the most captivating beach destinations in India. Divided into five districts—Thane, Raigad, Greater Bombay, Ratnagiri, and Sindhudurg—the coastline offers a diverse range of coastal experiences. Ganpatipule, with its golden sands and the ancient Swayambhu Ganesha Temple, is a serene retreat. Tarkarli, dubbed the 'Queen Beach' of Sindhudurg, enchants with pristine waters, which make it a hotspot for snorkelling and scuba diving. Vengurla, once a bustling trade centre, now beckons with beautiful beaches and lush plantations. Kunkeshwar's unspoiled tranquillity and the nearby Kunkeshwar Temple provide a peaceful escape. Velneshwar's rock-free shoreline invites swimmers and water sports enthusiasts, while its Shiva Temple and Anjanvel Fort add cultural charm. Maharashtra's beaches are a perfect blend of sun, sand, and cultural richness.


GANPATIPULE BEACH


PRATAPGAD FORTS

FORTS

Maharashtra's historical legacy shines through its impressive collection of over 350 forts, each bearing witness to the state's rich history. Many of these formidable strongholds were commissioned by Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj himself. These architectural marvels often blend land and sea, and hill and forest, making them not just historical sites but also prime destinations for adventure treks, especially during the monsoon.

Among these majestic forts, Sindhudurg Fort stands as a testament to Maratha valour, strategically constructed to serve as both a coastal stronghold and naval base. Inside its formidable walls lies the only temple ever built for Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj. Further south,